

Before the leap, the crucible

India's junior men's hockey squad enters a home World Cup with clear strengths, known weaknesses, and little margin for error. The tournament will indicate whether two years of structured preparation can **withstand elite pressure.**



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The stage is set in Chennai and Madurai for the FIH Men's Junior World Cup, placing the weight of a billion hopes on India's young brigade. Led by

defender Rohit and guided by the legendary P.R. Sreejesh, this two-time champion team is not just participating. It is aiming to reclaim the crown last won on home soil in 2016.

Fresh off a silver medal at the Sultan of Johor Cup, the India colts enter with momentum and the

distinct advantage of a passionate home crowd. **The injury to talismanic forward Araiyeet Singh Hundal poses a setback, but it also offers the squad a chance to rise beyond dependence on star power.**

Earlier this year, the junior side competed against top international opponents at the Four Nations